

# FretGarden

## Pedagogical Constitution

### Chapter 5 - Assessment Construction and Validity

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| Version              | 1.0                                                                                                                                                             |
| Status               | Foundational Draft                                                                                                                                              |
| Document Type        | Normative Pedagogical Standard                                                                                                                                  |
| Authority            | Binding on all FretGarden assessments, assessment-like exercises, progression checks, mastery decisions, diagnostics, review checks, and learner-facing claims. |
| Primary Dependencies | Foundation; Chapter 2 - Learning-Objective Taxonomy and Evidence Model; Chapter 3 - Lesson Architecture; Chapter 4 - Exercise Architecture and Drill Design.    |

This chapter defines how FretGarden constructs assessments that produce defensible evidence without distorting practice, overstating learning, or reducing musicianship to a score.

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# 1. Purpose

This chapter defines the standards by which FretGarden assessments are designed, administered, interpreted, and connected to educational decisions. It governs any activity whose result is used to infer what a learner knows, can perceive, can perform, can retain, can transfer, or is ready to learn next.

Assessment is not limited to formal tests. A brief exit check, a delayed review prompt, a metronome performance, an interval-identification task, a fretboard reconstruction, an improvisational constraint, or a learner self-diagnosis may all function as assessments when their results influence a claim or decision.

The purpose of assessment in FretGarden is not to generate scores for their own sake. Its purpose is to collect evidence that improves instruction, protects the integrity of progression, clarifies the learner's current capabilities, and supports honest claims about learning.

Governing rule: No assessment may be approved unless it defines the capability being measured, the evidence it collects, the interpretation permitted by that evidence, and the educational decision the result may influence.

## 2. Constitutional Authority

This chapter operationalizes the Foundation's requirements that assessment match the capability claimed, guessing not be rewarded as mastery, completion remain distinct from learning, and learner-facing progress language remain honest. It also operationalizes Chapter 2's evidence model, Chapter 3's exit and return phases, and Chapter 4's requirements for interpretable exercise evidence.

Where an assessment practice conflicts with these requirements, this chapter governs unless a later constitutional amendment explicitly supersedes it.

## 3. Assessment as an Inference System

An assessment does not directly reveal learning. It produces observations from which FretGarden makes an inference. The quality of the assessment depends on the defensibility of the relationship among the observed response, the intended capability, and the claim made afterward.

The complete assessment chain is:

- defined capability
- designed task
- learner response
- recorded evidence
- scoring or qualitative interpretation
- educational claim
- instructional or progression decision

Weakness at any point weakens the final claim. A precisely scored task can still be invalid if it measures the wrong capability. A valid task can still be misused if its result is interpreted too broadly. A strong score can still be misleading if the learner received support inconsistent with the claim.

Assessment principle: The strength of a claim MUST NOT exceed the strength, relevance, independence, breadth, recency, and consistency of the evidence supporting it.

## **4. Core Definitions**

### **4.1 Assessment**

Assessment is the deliberate collection and interpretation of evidence about a defined learner capability.

### **4.2 Assessment Task**

An assessment task is the bounded activity through which evidence is elicited. The task is not identical to the capability; it is a sample intended to reveal the capability.

### **4.3 Item**

An item is one scorable or interpretable prompt, example, performance demand, or decision within an assessment task.

### **4.4 Construct**

A construct is the capability or quality the assessment is intended to measure, such as note recall, interval discrimination, rhythmic stability, fretboard navigation, conceptual reasoning, or practice diagnosis.

### **4.5 Score**

A score is a summary of observed performance. A score may be numeric, categorical, dimensional, rubric-based, or descriptive. A score is evidence only when its meaning is defined.

### **4.6 Decision**

A decision is an educational action based partly or wholly on assessment evidence, such as recommending review, changing difficulty, granting progression, recording mastery, or allowing placement bypass.

### **4.7 Validity**

Validity is the degree to which evidence and theory support the interpretation and use of assessment results.

### **4.8 Reliability**

Reliability is the degree to which assessment results are sufficiently consistent for the decision being made.

### **4.9 Fairness**

Fairness is the degree to which assessment conditions allow learners to demonstrate the intended capability without irrelevant barriers or systematically distorted interpretation.

## 5. The Assessment Contract

Every consequential assessment MUST include an Assessment Contract. The contract may be stored in authoring documentation rather than displayed to the learner, but it must exist before approval.

- objective and construct
- purpose of the assessment
- content scope
- task format
- conditions and permitted support
- evidence source
- sampling plan
- quality dimensions
- scoring model
- decision rule
- claim limits
- known confounds
- feedback and next-step behavior
- reassessment rule
- review or expiration requirement

The Assessment Contract prevents a common failure in which the visible task is designed first and its meaning is invented afterward.

## 6. Assessment Purposes

### 6.1 Orientation

Determines whether the learner understands the representation, directions, terminology, or procedure required to participate. Orientation evidence must not be interpreted as musical mastery.

### 6.2 Diagnostic

Identifies the likely cause of difficulty and routes the learner toward targeted support.

### 6.3 Formative

Provides evidence during learning so instruction or practice can be adjusted.

### 6.4 Readiness

Determines whether prerequisite capabilities are sufficiently available for dependent material.

### 6.5 Retention

Determines whether a capability remains available after delay without complete re-teaching.

## 6.6 Transfer

Determines whether a learner can apply a capability under meaningfully changed conditions.

## 6.7 Fluency

Determines whether a capability is accurate, stable, efficient, and adaptable at the level required for use.

## 6.8 Mastery

Determines whether evidence is sufficient to support a scoped mastery claim.

## 6.9 Placement

Estimates the most appropriate entry point while protecting against hidden prerequisite gaps.

An assessment may serve more than one purpose only when the design supports each interpretation. Purposes **MUST NOT** be combined merely for efficiency.

# 7. Assessment Types

FretGarden recognizes selected-response, constructed-response, performance, perceptual, analytical, creative, self-evaluative, and longitudinal assessments. No type is inherently superior. Each type is appropriate only for constructs it can reveal with acceptable validity and fairness.

Selection rule: The assessment format **MUST** be chosen after the construct and evidence requirements are defined.

# 8. Alignment With Learning Objectives

Every assessment must align with the objective's capability, content, scope, conditions, support level, quality standard, developmental level, and time horizon.

Misalignment includes assessing only recognition when the objective requires recall; using a single memorized pattern when the objective requires fretboard transfer; assessing pitch while ignoring rhythm when temporal control is part of the objective; or requiring polished prose when the construct is musical reasoning.

Assessment writers must identify which parts of a task are construct-relevant and which are incidental.

# 9. Construct Definition

Before task construction, the intended construct must be defined narrowly enough to distinguish it from adjacent capabilities.

For example, "knows intervals" is not a usable construct. Possible constructs include auditory discrimination of major and minor thirds, free recall of interval formulas, physical construction from varied roots, functional recognition within chords, or fluent fretboard location.

A construct definition should specify what counts as evidence and what must not influence the result. If reading speed is not part of the construct, the task should not make reading speed decisive.

## 10. Validity Framework

Validity is not a property of an item in isolation. It concerns the interpretation and use of results. The same task may be valid for one claim and invalid for another.

FretGarden requires review across five dimensions: content validity, construct validity, instructional validity, consequential validity, and ecological validity.

## 11. Content Validity

Content validity concerns whether the sampled tasks adequately represent the objective's defined scope.

A fretboard-note assessment cannot support a broad claim if it samples only one string, one region, or highly familiar anchor notes. A rhythm assessment cannot support subdivision mastery if it omits rests, off-beat entries, or other features included in the objective.

Coverage rule: Assessment content **MUST** represent the meaningful breadth of the objective without requiring exhaustive testing of every possible item.

## 12. Construct Validity

Construct validity concerns whether the task actually requires the intended capability and avoids domination by unrelated demands.

Threats include visible pattern cues in a recall task, linguistic complexity in an auditory assessment, motor demands in a conceptual task, or answer-choice strategies that permit success without musical knowledge.

Assessment designers must conduct a false-success analysis: identify how a learner could succeed without possessing the target capability, then remove or constrain those paths.

## 13. Instructional Validity

Instructional validity concerns whether the assessment produces information that can guide learning.

A result is instructionally weak when it reduces performance to a score without identifying whether difficulty arose from recall, perception, rhythm, physical execution, or misunderstanding.

Consequential assessments should preserve enough dimensional information to support an appropriate next step.

## 14. Consequential Validity

Consequential validity concerns the behaviors and incentives created by assessment.

An assessment may be technically accurate yet pedagogically harmful if it encourages rushing, repeated guessing, avoidance of difficult material, dependence on visual cues, or practice aimed only at gaming the task format.

Consequence rule: An assessment **MUST NOT** reward behavior that contradicts FretGarden's practice philosophy or educational non-negotiables.

## 15. Ecological Validity

Ecological validity concerns whether evidence reflects the context in which the capability is intended to function.

Isolated tasks are useful for diagnosis and precision, but broad musicianship claims require at least some evidence from musically meaningful conditions. A learner who identifies chord tones in a grid has not necessarily demonstrated the ability to target them during a progression.

## 16. Reliability

Reliability must be sufficient for the consequence of the decision. A low-stakes practice suggestion may tolerate less evidence than a mastery designation or placement bypass.

Reliability is strengthened through multiple observations, representative sampling, clear criteria, equivalent item difficulty, reduced chance success, and consistent scoring. It must not be pursued by narrowing the task until the intended construct is no longer represented.

## 17. Fairness and Accessibility

Assessment must provide a fair opportunity to demonstrate the intended capability. Fairness does not require identical conditions when identical conditions create irrelevant barriers.

Alternate response methods MAY be used when they preserve the construct. A learner who cannot provide a typed explanation may demonstrate reasoning verbally or through structured construction when writing is not part of the objective.

Accommodations MUST NOT silently change the capability being claimed. When an accommodation changes the construct or level of independence, the resulting claim must reflect that change.

## 18. Evidence Sources

Assessment may use selected responses, constructed responses, instrumental performance, vocal or rhythmic performance, explanation, reconstruction, analysis, creation, self-evaluation, or longitudinal observation.

Broad claims SHOULD rely on converging evidence from more than one source. Narrow claims may rely on one source when that source directly represents the construct.

## 19. Item and Task Construction

Each item must serve a defined evidentiary purpose. Item wording, notation, examples, and controls should minimize irrelevant difficulty.

Items should avoid ambiguity unless resolving ambiguity is itself part of the construct. Distractors should reflect plausible errors rather than arbitrary alternatives. Correct answers should not be detectable through formatting, repetition patterns, or interface position.

Task difficulty must arise primarily from the intended capability.

## 20. Selected-Response Assessments

Selected-response formats include multiple choice, matching, binary decisions, and category selection. They are efficient and may validly assess recognition, discrimination, or classification.

They are generally insufficient as sole evidence for free recall, reconstruction, fluent navigation, or musical application.

Selected-response tasks **MUST** account for chance success through sufficient sampling, plausible alternatives, varied ordering, and interpretation rules that do not treat isolated correct answers as secure evidence.

## 21. Constructed-Response Assessments

Constructed-response tasks require the learner to produce an answer without the complete solution being visible. They provide stronger evidence of recall, reconstruction, explanation, or derivation.

Response evaluation must distinguish substantive musical accuracy from irrelevant differences in wording or notation. Where several correct representations exist, scoring criteria must recognize them.

## 22. Performance Assessments

Performance assessments require the learner to play, sing, clap, tap, count, or otherwise produce music in real time.

The Assessment Contract must identify which dimensions matter: pitch, rhythm, tone, articulation, coordination, tension, continuity, response to error, or musical intention.

A single successful take is weak evidence of stable performance. Repetition, variation, or delayed confirmation may be required depending on the claim.

## 23. Perceptual and Ear-Training Assessments

Perceptual assessments must require listening or audiation in a way that cannot be bypassed through visible structure. They should control register, timbre, root familiarity, context, and answer probability according to the construct.

Early discrimination tasks may use strong contrasts. Later assessments should vary examples and reduce incidental cues. A learner's ability to name a sound and ability to reproduce it should be treated as related but distinct evidence.

## 24. Temporal and Metronome Assessments

Temporal assessments must observe the learner's relationship to pulse, subdivision, meter, duration, rests, accents, and tempo.

Playing while a metronome sounds does not itself prove synchronization. Tasks should reveal whether attacks align with intended subdivisions and whether time remains stable when clicks become less frequent or temporarily absent.

## 25. Fretboard-Navigation Assessments

Fretboard assessments must vary roots, starting locations, string sets, fret regions, and representations according to scope. Permanent root markers or identical starting positions weaken evidence of navigation.

Shape reproduction may support a shape-specific claim. It cannot independently support note knowledge, interval understanding, or functional navigation.

## 26. Conceptual-Reasoning Assessments

Conceptual assessments should require explanation, derivation, comparison, analysis, prediction, or justification. Repeating a memorized definition is weak evidence unless precise definition recall is the construct.

Reasoning may be demonstrated through speech, diagrams, note selection, ordered steps, correction of an example, or physical demonstration. The response mode should not introduce unnecessary language demands.

## 27. Creative and Open-Ended Assessments

Creative assessments may have multiple valid outcomes. They must use explicit constraints and criteria that distinguish use of the target concept from general preference.

Rubrics should evaluate relevant features such as adherence to harmonic constraints, rhythmic coherence, intentional use of scale degrees, development of a motif, or justified revision. They must not reward stylistic conformity unrelated to the objective.

## 28. Metacognitive-Practice Assessments

Metacognitive assessments require learners to make or justify practice decisions. Agreeing with advice is not enough.

Valid evidence may include selecting an appropriate tempo, diagnosing a breakdown, choosing an isolation strategy, deciding when to stop, or revising a practice plan based on observed performance.

## 29. Prompting and Support Conditions

Support is part of the assessment condition and must be recorded. Full modeling, stepwise guidance, partial cues, root markers, visible formulas, count-ins, and metronome support may all alter the meaning of success.

An assessment intended to establish independence must remove direct solution support. If support is necessary for accessibility, the claim must specify the supported condition unless the support is construct-neutral.

## 30. Guessing, Chance, and False Success

FretGarden MUST distinguish evidence of knowledge from chance success, repeated guessing, process-of-elimination strategies, and interface exploitation.

A correct response following multiple unstructured attempts is not equivalent to first-attempt retrieval. Where retries are allowed for learning, the evidence record should distinguish the original attempt from corrected performance.

Guessing rule: Repeated attempts MAY support learning, but they MUST NOT be aggregated as though every eventual correct answer were independent evidence of mastery.

## 31. Sampling and Coverage

Assessments sample from a larger domain. Samples must be representative enough for the claim and proportionate to the decision.

Sampling plans should vary relevant dimensions and avoid overrepresentation of familiar anchors. Critical prerequisites and high-transfer objectives require broader sampling than low-stakes checks.

Adaptive sampling MAY request additional evidence when performance is inconsistent or near a decision threshold.

## 32. Scoring Models

Scoring may be binary, partial-credit, dimensional, rubric-based, confidence-weighted, or descriptive. The model must fit the construct.

A single aggregate percentage SHOULD NOT erase meaningful distinctions such as correct pitch with unstable rhythm, accurate recall with heavy prompting, or good conceptual reasoning with weak physical execution.

## 33. Rubrics

Rubrics are required when quality cannot be represented adequately by one correct answer.

A rubric must define observable dimensions, performance levels, and claim limits. Criteria must be musically relevant, distinct enough to guide scoring, and written so that two qualified reviewers can reach reasonably similar judgments.

Rubrics should avoid vague categories such as "good musicality" unless that phrase is decomposed into observable features.

## 34. Thresholds and Decision Rules

Thresholds convert evidence into decisions. They may include accuracy levels, consistency requirements, timing tolerances, rubric levels, delay requirements, transfer samples, or combinations of these.

No universal percentage should be applied across all constructs. A threshold must reflect the cost of error, prerequisite importance, task difficulty, chance level, and intended future use.

Borderline evidence should trigger additional sampling or a developing status rather than an unjustified binary judgment.

## 35. Confidence and Uncertainty

FretGarden should distinguish the estimated capability from confidence in that estimate. Sparse, inconsistent, old, or narrow evidence lowers confidence even when recent performance appears strong.

Uncertainty should be represented honestly. Missing evidence must not be converted into failure, and low confidence must not be presented as low ability.

## 36. Partial Success and Dimensional Results

Assessment should preserve partial success when it is instructionally meaningful. Correct notes with unstable rhythm, correct chord construction with incorrect spelling, or accurate self-correction after an initial error all contain different evidence.

Partial success may inform feedback and next steps. It must not be inflated into full mastery of dimensions that were not demonstrated.

## 37. Error Evidence

Assessment errors may reveal missing knowledge, unstable recall, misconception, physical breakdown, timing failure, transfer failure, or attention failure.

Consequential assessments SHOULD classify recurring errors when the evidence permits. Error categories must route instruction; they must not become fixed labels attached to the learner.

## 38. Retakes and Reassessment

Retakes may support learning and provide new evidence. They must be designed so that repeated exposure does not make the task easier through item memorization alone.

Where the same items are reused, the resulting evidence must be interpreted as supported by familiarity. Stronger reassessment uses equivalent but varied items and includes sufficient delay when retention is part of the claim.

## 39. Diagnostic Assessment

Diagnostic assessment isolates likely causes of difficulty. It should reduce unrelated demands, compare supported and unsupported performance, vary one factor at a time, and produce an actionable remediation path.

Diagnostic results must not be interpreted as mastery decisions unless the task separately satisfies mastery requirements.

## 40. Formative Assessment

Formative assessment occurs during learning and exists to alter the next instructional action. Its value depends on speed, relevance, and actionability rather than formal scoring.

A formative check is incomplete if the result does not affect feedback, practice conditions, scaffold level, or lesson routing.

## 41. Summative Assessment

Summative assessment summarizes capability at a defined boundary. It requires stronger sampling and claim discipline because its results may affect progression or learner identity.

Summative assessments must not be designed as surprise traps. They should assess capabilities the learner had a fair opportunity to develop while still requiring independent evidence.

## 42. Placement and Bypass Assessment

Placement assessments estimate the appropriate entry point for learners with prior experience. They should sample prerequisite networks rather than only advanced surface performance.

A learner may perform an advanced shape while lacking note, rhythm, or conceptual foundations. Bypass decisions therefore require evidence sufficient to protect dependent learning.

## 43. Delayed and Retention Assessment

Retention assessment occurs after a meaningful delay with minimal re-teaching. Review instructions may orient the learner but must not reconstruct the complete answer.

The delay should reflect the importance and expected use of the capability. Critical prerequisites require periodic revalidation.

## 44. Transfer Assessment

Transfer assessment changes conditions while preserving the underlying relationship. Variation may involve new roots, positions, keys, rhythms, representations, harmonic contexts, or musical purposes.

Cosmetic changes are insufficient. Reordering answer choices or changing display color does not establish transfer.

## 45. Fluency Assessment

Fluency assessment requires accuracy, stability, efficiency, and adaptability. Speed alone is insufficient.

Response-time or tempo requirements must be justified by intended use. The learner should retain control and recover from minor disruption without losing the underlying capability.

## 46. Mastery Assessment

Mastery assessment requires converging evidence appropriate to the objective: independent performance, stability, retention, relevant transfer, and domain-specific quality.

Mastery claims must be narrow enough to remain true. "Mastered major triad construction from natural-note roots in root position" is defensible; "mastered chords" is not.

## 47. Learner-Facing Reporting

Reports must distinguish what was observed from what is inferred. Language such as introduced, guided, independent in familiar conditions, retained, transferable, or mastered within scope is preferred to absolute declarations.

Feedback should identify strengths, unstable dimensions, confidence level where relevant, and the next educational action. It should not imply failure of character or talent.

## 48. Assessment Security and Item Exposure

When repeated exposure would weaken evidence, item pools, equivalent forms, or varied prompts should be used. Security exists to preserve validity, not to create secrecy for its own sake.

Learners should understand the capability being assessed even when exact items are not disclosed in advance.

## 49. Assessment Burden and Proportionality

Assessment consumes attention and practice time. The amount of evidence collected must be proportionate to the consequence of the decision.

FretGarden should avoid testing so frequently that learners optimize for evaluation rather than music-making. Practice should remain the primary activity; assessment should serve it.

## 50. Quality Assurance and Review

Consequential assessments require review before release and periodic review after use.

Review should examine alignment, construct clarity, false-success paths, fairness, item quality, scoring consistency, outcome patterns, learner behavior, and unintended incentives.

Unexpectedly high or low success rates are signals for investigation, not automatic proof that learners or items are defective.

## 51. Anti-Patterns

- labeling lesson completion as mastery
- using multiple choice as sole evidence of recall
- rewarding repeated guessing
- assessing speed before accuracy and control
- using one memorized pattern to claim fretboard fluency
- testing rhythm without observing pulse relationship
- requiring one universal fingering when fingering is not the construct
- using dense language to create artificial difficulty
- assigning broad mastery from narrow samples
- hiding uncertainty behind precise-looking percentages

- using the same exact items until memorization substitutes for learning
- combining diagnostic and mastery purposes without separate interpretation
- treating all errors as equivalent
- making assessment primarily a gamification event
- or allowing assessment preparation to replace musically meaningful practice

## 52. Constitutional Non-Negotiables

1. Every consequential assessment MUST have an Assessment Contract.
2. Every assessment MUST identify the construct and permissible claim.
3. Assessment format MUST follow the evidence need rather than convenience.
4. Recognition MUST NOT be reported as recall.
5. Prompted performance MUST NOT be reported as independent performance.
6. Immediate success MUST NOT be reported as retention.
7. Exact repetition MUST NOT be reported as transfer.
8. A single successful attempt MUST NOT establish stable capability or mastery.
9. Chance success and repeated guessing MUST be controlled or reflected in interpretation.
10. Scores MUST NOT erase relevant dimensions of performance.
11. Assessment difficulty MUST arise primarily from the intended construct.
12. Accommodations MUST preserve or explicitly qualify the construct.
13. Thresholds MUST be justified by the intended decision.
14. Missing evidence MUST NOT be treated as negative evidence.
15. Mastery claims MUST be scoped.
16. Learner-facing language MUST NOT exceed the evidence.
17. Assessment MUST NOT reward behavior that contradicts sustainable, accurate practice.
18. Assessment burden MUST be proportionate to its educational consequence.
19. Consequential assessments MUST receive quality review.
20. Every result used for progression MUST support the prerequisite claim being made.

## 53. Conformance Tests

1. What construct is being measured?
2. What objective and scope does it represent?
3. What response must the learner produce?
4. What support is permitted?
5. How could a learner succeed without possessing the construct?
6. How is guessing controlled?

7. What dimensions of quality are observed?
8. Is the sample representative?
9. What claim may the result support?
10. What claim may it not support?
11. How reliable must the result be for the decision?
12. What barriers unrelated to the construct may affect performance?
13. How will partial success be represented?
14. What will happen after an error?
15. What happens when evidence is borderline or contradictory?
16. When is reassessment required?
17. Does the assessment encourage desirable practice behavior?
18. Is the burden proportionate?
19. Can a reviewer explain why the interpretation is valid?
20. Would the learner-facing report remain honest if read literally?

## **54. Tradeoffs and Resolution Rules**

### **54.1 Efficiency Versus Evidence Strength**

Efficient formats may be used for low-stakes checks. Progression and mastery require evidence strong enough for the consequence.

### **54.2 Control Versus Musical Authenticity**

Controlled tasks diagnose components; authentic tasks reveal integration. Broad claims should use both where feasible.

### **54.3 Consistency Versus Learner Diversity**

Criteria should remain stable while response modes may vary when they preserve the construct.

### **54.4 Transparency Versus Item Exposure**

Learners should know what capability matters without necessarily seeing every future item.

### **54.5 Precision Versus False Exactness**

Quantification is useful only when the measurement supports it. Descriptive uncertainty is preferable to unjustified numerical precision.

### **54.6 Momentum Versus Readiness Protection**

Borderline evidence should produce additional sampling, supported progression, or targeted review rather than automatic advancement or punitive failure.

## 55. Assumptions Made

- FretGarden will use assessment throughout learning rather than only at unit boundaries.
- Some evidence will be collected on the instrument and some through other response modes.
- Progression and mastery decisions will rely on more than completion.
- Assessment results can remain multidimensional.
- Later chapters will define domain-specific thresholds and review intervals.
- Equivalent forms or item variation will be available where repeated exposure matters.
- Learners may require accessible alternative response methods.
- Human and automated evaluation may both be used, subject to later reliability standards.
- Assessment should support learner independence rather than permanent external judgment.
- Assessment data will be interpreted pedagogically rather than treated as self-explanatory.

## 56. Unresolved Questions

- standard retention intervals by objective type
- minimum sampling requirements for mastery
- confidence-calculation methods
- acceptable tolerances for rhythmic timing
- rubric calibration for creative work
- limits of automated audio and performance evaluation
- placement-bypass requirements
- when item exposure materially invalidates evidence
- learner appeal or challenge procedures
- handling performance anxiety and situational variability
- evidence portability across tunings and instruments
- and how assessment results should be displayed without encouraging compulsive optimization

## 57. Topics Intentionally Deferred

- mastery thresholds and progression policy
- review scheduling and retention intervals
- feedback taxonomy and wording
- error classification and remediation routing
- adaptive assessment algorithms
- educational analytics
- automated scoring reliability
- creative-work rubric libraries

- accessibility standards
- assessment data governance
- placement architecture
- and constitutional amendment and audit procedures

## 58. Required Future Cross-References

### 58.1 Mastery, Readiness, and Progression Chapter

Must reference the Assessment Contract, validity framework, thresholds, confidence, mastery assessment, and claim limits.

### 58.2 Review, Retention, and Spaced Retrieval Chapter

Must reference delayed assessment, evidence expiration, reassessment, and retention claims.

### 58.3 Feedback and Error Classification Chapter

Must reference dimensional results, error evidence, formative assessment, and learner-facing reporting.

### 58.4 Remediation and Adaptive Difficulty Chapter

Must reference diagnostic assessment, partial success, support conditions, and borderline evidence.

### 58.5 Domain-Specific Pedagogy Chapters

Must define valid task formats, quality dimensions, thresholds, and transfer conditions without weakening this chapter.

### 58.6 Educational Analytics Chapter

Must preserve the distinction among observations, scores, evidence, confidence, claims, and decisions.

## 59. Chapter Conformance Statement

A FretGarden assessment conforms to this chapter only when it elicits evidence relevant to a defined construct, records the conditions under which that evidence was produced, uses an interpretation appropriate to the evidence strength, and supports an educational action without overstating learning.

An assessment is not valid merely because it produces a score, resembles a familiar test format, is difficult, or correlates with lesson completion. It must create a defensible chain from objective to task, from task to evidence, from evidence to claim, and from claim to decision.

Final rule: Assessment exists to improve and protect learning. It **MUST NOT** become a substitute for learning, a distortion of practice, or a source of claims stronger than the evidence permits.

End of Chapter 5 - Assessment Construction and Validity